

The Numbers They Gave Us

Every figure the Government of Alberta has attached to the AISH to ADAP change, set against its own published record. Complete report, September 2026.

Five research phases. Eight Estimates volumes, 268 Hansard transcripts, the Act and the regulation, the Gazette, the Fiscal Plan, every Auditor General publication since 2024, Alberta Purchasing Connect, thirteen jurisdictions' own rate tables, and Statistics Canada. Every document opened at its source.

How to read this, and the tags used throughout

VERIFIED — read off a government document that was opened, with the printed page recorded.

ARITHMETIC — computed by us from two or more verified figures. **These are ours, not the government's**, and they are labelled everywhere they appear.

NOT ESTABLISHED — looked for and not found, with a record of where we looked.

Effect, not motive. Nothing here says why a figure was chosen or why a measure differs. It records what was published and where the figures sit relative to one another.

Figures are as published on the dates given. **If something has changed since, the source is named so it can be checked.**

Every document behind this report is listed in the companion *Source Index* — what each source is, who issued it, when, where it lives, what was taken from it, and what could not be reached.

1. There is no published figure for what the change costs or saves

This was the question the research set out to answer. Five phases later the answer has not changed, and the absence now has a shape.

Where we looked

Eight consecutive Government Estimates volumes, 2019-20 through 2026-27. In each: the Expense Vote by Program table, the Description of Supply Vote Programs, the Amounts to be Voted table, the Amounts Not Required to be Voted table, the Contingency Vote by Program table, the Reconciliation by Program table and the Statement of Operations.

The 2024-2025 Annual Report, including the Lapse and Encumbrance schedule and the Statement of Revenues and Expenses.

268 Hansard transcripts, House and committee, 1 January 2025 to the last sitting.

The Act, AR 96/2026, AR 87/2026, and the Gazette for May 2026.

Every Auditor General of Alberta publication from 1 January 2024 to 15 September 2026, and the forward audit plan.

Alberta Purchasing Connect, every relevant posting and the awards sweep from 2023.

Result: no line, no sub-element, no footnote, no quotation and no figure attached to the transition, in either direction.

And the shape of it: three changes costed, one not

Printed pages 83 and 84 of the Budget 2026 Fiscal Plan carry four changes in this ministry.

Change, as printed in the Fiscal Plan	Costing given	Source
Income Support, Expected to Work — legislated six-month maximum duration	\$44M in 2026-27, rising to \$177M by 2028-29	<i>Fiscal Plan 2026-29, printed p.83. VERIFIED.</i>
Persons with Developmental Disabilities — price and cost-driver work	up to \$223M by 2028-29	<i>Fiscal Plan, printed p.83. VERIFIED.</i>
Alberta Seniors Benefit — thresholds reduced 9 per cent	\$23M in 2026-27, \$31M thereafter	<i>Fiscal Plan, printed p.83. VERIFIED.</i>
AISH to ADAP — the same passage gives the start date, the \$1,740 rate, the \$200 transition benefit and the 31 December 2027 end date	no figure	<i>Fiscal Plan, printed pp.83-84. VERIFIED by absence.</i>

The government costs changes to disability and seniors programs. It costed three of them on those two pages.

Across all 180 pages of the Fiscal Plan, the phrase Disability Income Assistance appears once, in the ministry expense table.

The Auditor General has not examined the change and has not scheduled an examination. Every publication from January 2024 to September 2026 was enumerated. The ministry's 2025-26 annual report has not been published.

2. Three budget lines, same ministry, same two years

Comparing the last closed year that has a reported figure with the current estimate.

Budget element	Figures as printed	Source
Element 3.2 — Financial Assistance Grants. The money paid to people as benefits.	2024-25 reported \$1,632,688,000 2026-27 estimate \$1,609,762,000	2024-2025 Annual Report, printed p.127; 2026-27 Estimates. VERIFIED.
Element 3.1 — Program Planning and Delivery. Administration, described in 2026-27 as covering AISH and ADAP.	2024-25 reported \$40,570,000 2026-27 estimate \$88,399,000	2024-2025 Annual Report; 2026-27 Estimates. VERIFIED.
Element 2.4 — Career and Employment Services.	2024-25 reported \$81,053,000 2026-27 estimate \$246,800,000	2024-2025 Annual Report; 2026-27 Estimates. VERIFIED.

The same three lines as arithmetic. These calculations are ours.

Benefits: down about \$23 million. \$1,632,688,000 less \$1,609,762,000.

Administration: up about \$48 million, more than doubling. \$88,399,000 less \$40,570,000, which is 2.18 times the reported figure.

Employment services: just over three times larger. \$246,800,000 divided by \$81,053,000.

ARITHMETIC. No Government of Alberta document states any of these three differences.

And the administration jump has a published explanation. See below. Any statement about element 3.1 must carry it.

What the ministry said about the administration line

In estimates, the Assistant Deputy Minister and Senior Financial Officer explained roughly \$45 million of the element 3.1 increase as a reclassification between element 2.1 and element 3.1, anticipating program delivery implementation expense for the AISH and ADAP changes.

That explanation is on the record and travels with the figure. One thing was not resolved in the room: element 2.1 was given as rising from \$157 million to \$168 million in the same period, a rise of \$11 million, while \$45 million was described as moving out of it. No member followed up.

The administration line before 2026-27

Period	Amount	Source
2019-20 through 2025-26, estimates	between \$31,358,000 and \$42,662,000	Estimates volumes, each year. VERIFIED.
2024-25 reported	\$40,570,000	2024-2025 Annual Report, p.127
2026-27 estimate	\$88,399,000	2026-27 Estimates

Seven years inside a band of about eleven million dollars, then a single-year increase of roughly forty-six million on the estimate.

The caution on element 2.4

In every closed year that could be checked, this line spent less than it was budgeted: \$72.3M budgeted against \$62.9M reported in 2018-19; \$66.6M against \$64.6M in 2019-20; \$69.6M against \$57.8M in 2020-21; \$95.9M against \$81.1M in 2024-25. **A budgeted figure and a spent figure on this line have not been the same thing**, and the 2026-27 column is an estimate for a year that has not begun.

3. What the law does, and what it leaves to a Minister

Four provisions people are not told about

The transfer cannot be appealed. AISH Act s.12.8: "For greater certainty, a formerly eligible client has no right of appeal with respect to the formerly eligible client's transition under section 12.6 to the Alberta disability assistance program."

The statute says the benefit may be lower. s.12.6(2): the amount "may be less than the amount or value of the same type of benefit the formerly eligible client received or was eligible to receive under section 3 of the former Act."

The \$200 and the end date are not in the law. Schedule 3 s.13 of AR 96/2026 creates the transition benefit and states no amount and no end date. s.12(3): "the amount of a personal benefit is the amount determined by the Minister." The figure \$200 and the date 31 December 2027 appear nowhere in the Act or the regulation. **What a Minister sets, a Minister can reset.**

The employment condition applies to ADAP alone. AR 96/2026 s.15(4) lets a director refuse, suspend, vary or discontinue a benefit where a client has refused or reduced "**reasonable employment**" — a phrase the regulation does not define. There is no equivalent provision for AISH.

Both rates sit in one section of one regulation

Rate	Amount	Where it lives
AISH living allowance	\$1,940	AR 96/2026 s.8(2)
ADAP living allowance	\$1,740	AR 96/2026 s.8(3)
Two clients in one household	88 per cent each	AR 96/2026 s.8(4)

The commencement date

Three legal sources say 2 July 2026. The proclamation in Alberta Gazette Part I, Vol. 122 No. 10, printed page 726, witnessed 14 May 2026. The face of AR 96/2026, filed 12 May, in force 2 July. The King's Printer consolidation. Two client-facing documents say the same.

Two government sources say 1 July 2026. The Fiscal Plan at printed page 83, and the minister eleven times in the Chamber and in committee, the last on 5 May — nine days before the proclamation was signed. **1 July 2026 was Canada Day**, and the proclamation set commencement on the following business day.

For anyone calculating a transition benefit, the operative date is the one in the regulation. A benefit calculated from the announced date is out by a month.

4. What was said in the Legislature

The ADAP rate has never been spoken in the Legislature

\$1,740 was searched as a raw string across all 119 House transcripts from 25 February 2025 and across the ministry estimates transcripts. It appears nowhere.

Twenty-one times a government speaker cited a monthly rate while defending the change. Every one cited the AISH rate. Twelve at \$1,901, eight at \$1,940, one gave both. Nineteen from the minister, two from the Premier.

Recorded as found. No characterisation of intent.

The comparison figures, traced between two sittings

18 March 2025, the minister, with the basis stated: "with the AISH rate remaining at \$1,901 per month, that is \$554 higher than Manitoba, \$533 higher than Ontario, \$515 higher than Saskatchewan, and \$417 higher than B.C."

30 October 2025, the same minister: "ADAP will also be the highest in the country. In fact, it's \$554 higher than NDP Manitoba, \$417 higher than NDP B.C." No rate named.

Tested against each province's own current rate table, ADAP at \$1,740 is \$325.63 above Manitoba and \$256.50 above British Columbia. **ARITHMETIC — our subtraction of two published figures.**

One version states the basis differently. 6 May 2025, printed page 3201: "At \$1,901 a month plus about \$400 in medical benefits, that puts us over \$554 higher than Manitoba." No other version says medical benefits are included.

The rates, read at each government's own table

Jurisdiction	Rate as published	Basis
Alberta AISH	\$1,940	AR 96/2026 s.8(2). Flat rate, no shelter component.
Alberta ADAP	\$1,740	AR 96/2026 s.8(3). Flat rate, no shelter component.
Ontario	\$1,436	Ontario's own printed total, effective 1 July 2026.
Saskatchewan	\$1,289 Tier A / \$1,214 Tier B	Living Income Benefit, effective 1 September 2026.
British Columbia	\$983.50 support + up to \$500 shelter	Effective 1 December 2025.
Manitoba	\$598.37 support + \$816 shelter	Regulation in effect since 1 July 2026.

Every one of these is a different shape. Alberta pays a flat legislated rate. British Columbia and Ontario pay a base plus shelter up to a cap only reached by someone whose rent is at or above it. Any single-number comparison hides that, in every direction. **Seven jurisdictions were not established or not collected and nothing is recorded for them.**

5. The contracts

Award	Value	Source and status
Serco Canada — Prime Contractor South	\$50,941,933.78	APC AB-2025-06143. VERIFIED.
AKG Canada — Prime Contractor North	\$46,963,570.99	APC AB-2025-06143. VERIFIED.
Total combined value of all awards on that posting	\$97,905,504.77	APC's own printed total. VERIFIED.
AKG Canada — Calgary posting	\$3,807,447.00	APC AB-2025-01476, effective 1 September 2025. VERIFIED.
AKG's two awards added together	\$50,771,017.99	ARITHMETIC — our addition. APC prints this nowhere.
Work Based Learning posting, 23 awards	\$161,613,208.00	APC AB-2025-03125. Not an ADAP posting. VERIFIED.

What the contracts do not tell the public

Whether any of these contracts sit inside element 2.4 is NOT ESTABLISHED. No source examined connects a posting to an Estimates element. **Do not join them.**

The contract terms are not public. All eight attachments on AB-2025-06143 sit behind a sign-in and the document endpoint returns HTTP 401. No account was created and no form was submitted.

"Stream C" is not defined in any public document, and neither AISH nor ADAP is named anywhere in the posting.

Whether the contracts contain employment outcome requirements is NOT CHECKED.

Alberta Purchasing Connect cannot be searched by awardee. Nothing here supports a claim about the total any company holds.

A figure of 26,800 ADAP clients referred to contractors is NOT ESTABLISHED and appears in no government document opened in this research.

6. How success is measured

Performance Measure 2.a, quoted in full

"Percentage of participants employed after receiving Career and Employment Information Services: workshops, exposure courses, job placements, and Disability Related Employment Supports"

"The target of 65 per cent demonstrates the ministry's effectiveness in helping Albertans get back to work. In 2024, 67 per cent of participants were employed after receiving Career and Employment Information Services."

Targets: 2026 — 65%. 2027 — 65%. 2028 — 65%.

Recorded plainly: the reported 2024 result is 67 per cent. The target for each of the following three years is 65 per cent, two points below it, and it does not rise across the period in which ADAP is implemented.

Source: Assisted Living and Social Services Business Plan 2026-29. VERIFIED.

The investment plan measures employment on every stream but one

Investment stream	Who it serves	How success is measured
Medium-Intensity Services	Moderately barriered job seekers.	"[x]% increase in Moderately Barriered Individuals employed"
Strategic Employment Partnerships	Job seekers with multiple barriers.	"[x]% increase in Multi-Barriered Individuals employed"
Employment Campaign	Unemployed Albertans and employers.	"[x]% increase in ... Albertans employed"
High-Intensity Services	Carries the Prime Contractor Framework for highly barriered job seekers.	"[X]% increase of volume / capacity" "[X]% increase in employers partnered with Employment Services"

Source: Employment Services Investment Plan 2026-27, published on Alberta Purchasing Connection, reference AB-2026-06234. **Every percentage in the plan is a placeholder, on every stream. What differs is the quantity being counted, not the number.** The word employed does not appear in the High-Intensity measures.

7. The population, and who counts it

Alberta published the figure its own members have not used

Treasury Board and Finance, June 2025, *2022 Canadian Survey of Disability, Persons with Disabilities in Alberta*, ISBN 978-1-4601-6345-0: "In 2022, 27.5% (906,100) of Albertans aged 15 and over had one or more disabilities, which was slightly higher than the national proportion, at 27.0% (8.0 million)."

In late November and early December 2025, a minister and a government member said "1 in 5 Albertans." Their own government had published 27.5 per cent five months earlier.

1 in 5 was the 2017 survey figure. The 2022 survey was released 1 December 2023.

Almost one in four working-age Albertans, aged 25 to 64, has a disability. That is the relevant denominator for an employment argument.

The line in Alberta's own publication that nobody quotes

The same Treasury Board summary reports that **in 2022 Alberta had the highest share of persons with disabilities who experienced at least one barrier to accessibility of any province in Canada, at 74.0 per cent.**

Alberta's disability rate also rose faster than Canada's between 2017 and 2022.

Alberta does not measure its own disabled population

- **No Alberta survey, registry or provincial prevalence estimate was located.** The only Alberta-published prevalence data is a summary of the federal survey, plus open-data tables carrying 2012 figures.
- **What Alberta measures is caseload** — how many people receive a program. That is a different number from how many people have a disability, and the second has no Alberta source.
- **In 2017-18 the ministry reported four disability-related outcome measures. By 2023-24 the only one remaining is how quickly AISH applications are adjudicated.**

The employment ranking claim

On the 2022 survey, employment rate for persons with disabilities aged 25 to 64: **Saskatchewan 67.0, Quebec 66.7, Alberta 66.4**, British Columbia 65.0, Canada 61.8. **Alberta ranks third on the point estimates.**

Alberta's confidence interval is 63.5 to 69.2 and contains both Saskatchewan and Quebec, so the survey cannot statistically separate the top three. The claim is not supported on the point estimates and cannot be called false. **Both halves of that must travel together.**

8. The Canada Disability Benefit, jurisdiction by jurisdiction

Jurisdiction and treatment	Instrument	Date
ALBERTA — counts it as income	AR 96/2026 Schedule 1, s.6(1)(e), s.7(1), s.7(2)	<i>In force 2 July 2026. VERIFIED.</i>
British Columbia — exempt	Employment and Assistance policy manual	<i>Read 15 Sep 2026</i>
Saskatchewan — exempt	Government news release	<i>20 June 2025</i>
Manitoba — exempt	Assistance Regulation, M.R. 404/88 R, s.8(1)(b)	<i>Current</i>
Ontario — exempt	ODSP Policy Directives	<i>Updated 20 May 2026</i>
Quebec — exempt	Règlement sur l'aide aux personnes et aux familles	<i>In force 1 April 2026</i>
New Brunswick — exempt	Department of Social Development release	<i>4 July 2025</i>
Newfoundland and Labrador — exempt	Income and Employment Support Regulations	<i>Current</i>
Nova Scotia, PEI, Yukon, NWT, Nunavut	NOT ESTABLISHED	<i>Not named in the exemption lists. None states that it counts the benefit.</i>

The federal government named one province, and it is Alberta

Question Period Note, *Canada Disability Benefit*, Employment and Social Development Canada, prepared for the Minister of Jobs and Families, 17 November 2025:

"Alberta: We are disappointed that the Government of Alberta has decided to claw back the Canada Disability Benefit from their social assistance benefits, including under its Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) program."

The same note records the federal position that it has called on provinces and territories to exempt the benefit from counting as income.

Alberta is the only jurisdiction named in a treatment context in that note.

The form of words the evidence carries

Alberta is the only jurisdiction in Canada whose own regulation names the Canada Disability Benefit as income. Seven other provinces exempt it, each confirmed from that province's own regulation, policy manual or ministerial release. Five jurisdictions could not be established either way, and none of the five states that it counts the benefit.

The carve-out that must travel with it: AR 96/2026 Schedule 1 s.7(2) exempts the benefit only when determining eligibility for, and the amount of, a modified living allowance — the benefit for a person residing in a facility. For everyone else on AISH and ADAP, it counts.

Count as at 15 September 2026: one counts it, seven exempt it, five unestablished.

What this report does not claim

- **It does not attribute motive** anywhere. Where a target sits below a reported result, or a measure counts a different quantity, that is recorded. Why is not.
- **It does not say the government has claimed a saving from the change.** No such figure was located in five phases. That is recorded as an absence with the search described.
- **It does not join a contract to a budget element.** No source examined connects them.
- **It does not include third-party analysis.** Every figure comes from a government document or a Statistics Canada table.
- **Seven jurisdictions' rates were not established or not collected,** and nothing is recorded for them in either direction.
- **Every ARITHMETIC figure is ours.** Subtraction and division on printed numbers, labelled wherever it appears.

The four questions this report leaves on the table

Where is the figure? Three changes costed on two printed pages of the Fiscal Plan. This one costed nowhere, in eight Estimates volumes, 268 Hansard transcripts, the Act, the regulation, and every Auditor General publication since 2024.

Why does administration more than double? Roughly \$45 million is explained as a reclassification. The remainder, and the element 2.1 figures that do not reconcile with it, were not put to anyone.

Why is employment measured on every investment stream except the one serving the most disabled job seekers?

Why was the ADAP rate never said in the Legislature? Twenty-one citations of a monthly rate in defence of the change, every one of them the AISH rate.

Every figure in this report was printed by the Government of Alberta or by Statistics Canada.

The only things that are ours are the arrangement, and the subtraction.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown

albertadisabilitysystembreakdown.netlify.app · albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com

Sources: Government Estimates 2019-20 to 2026-27; 2024-2025 Annual Report; Budget 2026 Fiscal Plan; ALSS Business Plan 2026-29; Employment Services Investment Plan 2026-27; AISH Act; AR 96/2026; AR 87/2026; Alberta Gazette Part I Vol.122 No.10; Alberta Hansard, 268 transcripts; Alberta Purchasing Connect AB-2025-06143, AB-2025-01476, AB-2025-03125, AB-2026-06234; Treasury Board and Finance, *Persons with Disabilities in Alberta*, June 2025; Statistics Canada Tables 13-10-0374-01 and 13-10-0377-01; ESDC Question Period Note, 17 November 2025; and the published rate tables of six provinces.

Research completed 15 September 2026. Compiled September 2026.